Lumen brand guidelines

A practical identity for calm, precise software. Edition 3 replaces every earlier edition from 1 October 2026.

These guidelines describe how Lumen looks and sounds wherever people meet it: in the product, on the website, in documentation, and on the invoices and letters we send. They are short on purpose: when a case is not covered, choose the quieter option.

> **Promise** Calm, precise tools that respect people's attention.
>
> **Colour** Lumen Indigo leads; Signal Coral appears at most once per view.
>
> **Type** Public Sans for everything people read; Source Code Pro for code.
>
> **Voice** Direct, never abrupt. Technical, never opaque. Warm, never ornamental.

1 The idea

Lumen started as a planning tool for teams who were tired of noise. The identity keeps that promise: “a small light that makes the next step obvious”. Every element should help someone see, decide, or act, and nothing should compete for attention without a reason.

- **Clarity first.** One idea per screen, per slide, per paragraph.
- **Quiet confidence.** Generous whitespace instead of loud colour or effects.
- **Honest detail.** Real numbers, real screenshots, and plain claims we can prove.

2 Colour

The palette pairs a deep indigo with a warm dawn light. Indigo, Teal, and Ink carry text and interface; Coral and Amber are *accents* and never set body text, because neither reaches 4.5:1 contrast on white. Tints serve backgrounds and data series.

Figure 1. The palette with 25, 50, and 75 percent tints

Table 1. Palette values and contrast against white

Colour	Role	Hex	sRGB	Contrast
Core				
Lumen Indigo	Headings, the mark, key actions	`#2B2D6E`	`43 45 110`	12.3 : 1
Harbour Teal	Secondary actions, data series	`#167872`	`22 120 114`	5.3 : 1
Ink	Body text and interface copy	`#1E2230`	`30 34 48`	15.8 : 1
Accent (never for text)				
Signal Coral	Highlights, bands, one per view	`#F2665A`	`242 102 90`	3.1 : 1
Dawn Amber	The light in the mark, charts	`#F5B83D`	`245 184 61`	1.8 : 1

3 Typography

Public Sans is our only typeface for reading. Hierarchy comes from size and colour; bold marks a key term and italics a stressed word, never a whole sentence. Code, colour values, and keyboard input use Source Code Pro, as in `--lumen-indigo: #2B2D6E` or `lumen export --pdf`.

Table 2. The type scale, in points

Role	Size	Leading	Use
Display	34	40	Covers and one bold title per document
Heading	16	22	Section openings, bold, in Lumen Indigo
Body	10.5	15.5	Running text and table cells, in Ink
Caption	10.5	15.5	Figure and table captions

4 The mark

The mark is a disc with a smaller light rising from its upper right over a horizon line. It always appears whole, upright, and on one of three approved grounds. Keep a clear space of one sixth of its width on every side.

Figure 2. The three approved grounds

1. Never place the mark on photography without a solid ground behind it.
2. Never recolour the light: it is Dawn Amber, or white on an amber ground.
3. Never set the mark smaller than 16 pt on paper or 24 px on screen.

5 Voice

We write the way a thoughtful colleague speaks: specific, brief, and kind. We name the thing, give the number, and say what happens next.

Table 3. Voice in practice

We write	We avoid
Your export is ready. It has 14 pages.	Awesome! Your shiny new export is good to go!
We could not reach the server. Try again in a minute.	Oops, something went wrong.
Plans start at USD 12 per editor each month.	Unbeatable value for teams of every size.
Undo restores the last 50 changes.	Never lose work again, guaranteed.

6 Before you publish

Run through this list for anything that carries the Lumen name, from a release note to a conference banner.

- Colours come from the tokens in Table 1, never from a picker.
- Text is Ink or Indigo on white or Mist; accents never carry words.
- The mark has its clear space and sits on an approved ground.
- Every claim has a number, and every number has a source.
- Generated files pass `lumen lint --brand` with no warnings.

Brand Studio Ana Okafor, Head of Brand · brand@lumen.example. Ask before you publish anything new that carries the mark.

Assets Logos, tokens, and templates: lumen.example/brand